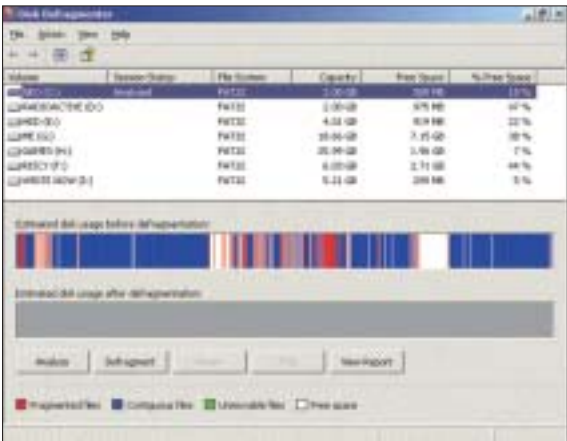


than the one where Windows is installed. This way you will ensure better performance, and also not risk corrupting your hard drive. Back up your data on another hard disk—if you don't have one, use a friend's. ScanDisk: Before running Scandisk, close all other applications using their close commands—**File > Exit**—and not through End task in the Task Manager. Now, open My Computer, right-click on your C drive and select Properties. Go to **Tools > Check Now**, select 'Automatically fix file system errors' and 'Scan for and attempt recovery of bad sectors', and click Start. After ScanDisk is done checking the drive, reboot the PC and repeat the process for all your partitions and drives. In Windows XP, you will not be able to scan the Boot drive (the drive on which Windows is loaded), while Windows is running; instead you can schedule Error-checking for the next time the computer starts. Now reboot your computer, and let Scandisk run.



The Windows 2000 and XP Defragmenter shows a graphical chart of the files stored on your computer

Disabling Safety Sweep

Fast and Safe Cleanup does not clean files that it marks as yellow or red—files it thinks are important or cannot be deleted. So to remove these files, you will have to disable the Safety Sweep feature in CleanSweep by going to **Options > Norton CleanSweep** in Norton SystemWorks' main window. Set the Safety Sweep option to 'Off'.

Caution: Be careful when deleting files, as you may delete an important file such as a Windows system file, or a DLL file shared by an existing program.



Defragment your hard disk regularly with the help of Windows Defragmenter

Disk defragmenter: After running ScanDisk, you need to defragment your data. This makes your hard disk faster and more organised, and should ideally be done every 15 days. To start this utility, go to **Start > Programs > Accessories > System Tools > Disk Defragmenter**, select the drive that you want to defragment first, and click on Defragment. In Windows 98 or Me, set the utility to 'Rearrange files so my programs start faster' and 'Check the drive for errors', and set the 'I want to use these options' to 'Everytime I defragment my hard drive'. This is so that you won't have to choose each time you run Disk Defragmenter, whether you want it to arrange your frequently used programs at the beginning of the drive (where they can be accessed faster). In Windows 2000 or XP, you get the

option to Analyze or Defragment. Choose Analyze to see how fragmented the drive is, and you will be told whether defragmenting is required. If so, click Defragment to see a graphical representation of the Defragmentation process taking place. Do this for all your drives.

In-house maintenance

Third-party hard disk managers are also available. Though heavy on your pocket, they do a more precise job



You can change a lot of settings in Norton Disk Doctor before defragmenting

of maintenance than Windows does. Norton Utilities: One of the most popular and precise applications is Norton Utilities. This suite does a perfect job of hard disk maintenance. The Suite features a module called Norton Disk Doctor that does a thorough job of correcting file errors. Install Norton Disk Doctor, and start it by going to **Start > Programs > Norton SystemWorks > Norton Utilities > Find and Fix Problems > Norton Disk Doctor**. Press Continue and a window, where you can see a list of installed drives or partitions, pops up. Select the drives you want to scan by checking the boxes next to them. Click on Options; in the dialog that pops up, select 'Enable Free Space testing', and click OK. Finally, select 'Fix Errors' in the main screen and press Diagnose to start checking your drives. Ontrack SystemSuite: Another utility that is widely used is the Ontrack SystemSuite. This suite is quite advanced and very user-friendly. It offers a wide range of features, such as DiskFixer that



Change Ontrack's options to control the way it scans your hard disk